

Presentation Replication Paper Quants II + Extension

Personality Traits and Vote Switching: A Tale of Open-Minded Switchers and Agreeable Populism Resisters” by David Hamann and Sebastian Jäckle (2025)

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Introduction

- Which personality traits influence vote switching?
- Two interests:
 - General vote switching at least once across waves
 - Populism susceptibility: switching to AfD (Alternative für Deutschland) at least once
- Two logistic regression models M1 & M2; DV = Vote Switching Yes/No
- Online Panel data from Germany, 3 waves, N = 4351

- IVs: Big Five personality traits (OCEAN):
 - Openness: imaginative, curious, and open to new ideas and experiences
 - Conscientiousness: organized, disciplined, and goal-oriented
 - Extraversion: sociable, energetic, and seeks/enjoys company of others
 - Agreeableness: compassionate, cooperative, and trusting
 - Neuroticism: how prone to experiencing negative emotions such as anxiety, moodiness, and emotional instability

Hypotheses and Results: General Vote Switching

Hypotheses

- Openness ↑
- Conscientiousness ↓
- Extraversion ↓
- Agreeableness ↑
- Neuroticism: no clear expectation



Results

- Openness ↑
- Conscientiousness ↑ (!!)
- Extraversion: no effect
- Agreeableness: no effect
- Neuroticism: weak ↑

Hypotheses and Results: AfD Vote Switching

Hypotheses

- Openness ↓
- Agreeableness ↓
- Conscientiousness ↑
- Neuroticism ↑
- Extraversion: no expectation



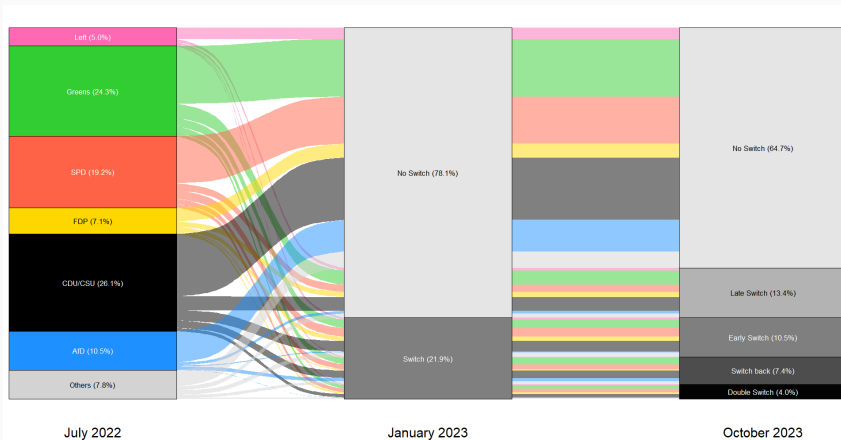
Results

- Openness ↓
- Agreeableness ↓
- Conscientiousness ↑
- Extraversion no effect
- Neuroticism: ↓
- Left-right self-placement
strongest predictor

Replication

Replication Approach

- Reproduced:
 - Figures 2 to 6 → worked mostly well; minor visual differences only
 - Models M1 and M2 → exact same result, same direction and magnitude of effects



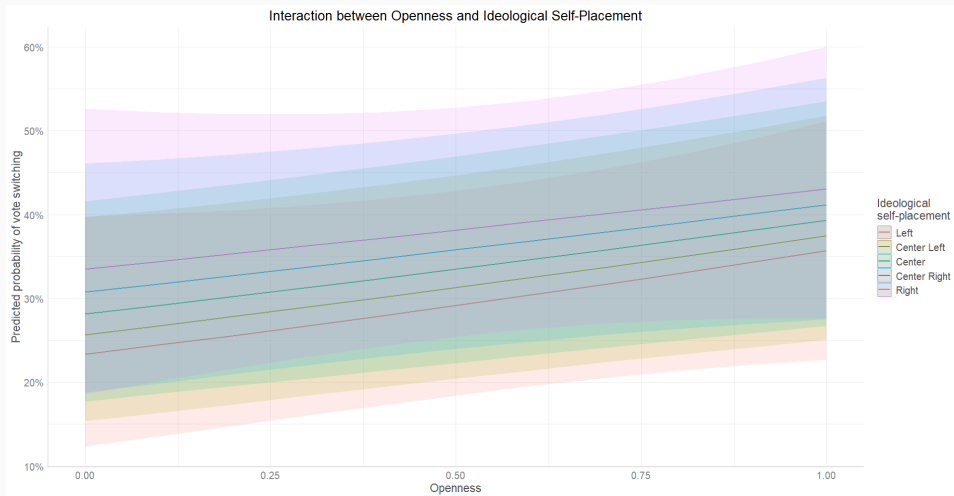
Extensions

Extensions: Diagnostics & Interaction Effect (M1)

- No multicollinearity ($VIF \approx 1$)
- Logit linearity assumption holds
- Interaction Effect
 - Tested: Openness $\times$ ideology (left-right placement, 5 point scale)
 - Theoretically justified: openness shapes how strongly individuals rely on ideological cues
 - Core idea: Party loyalty not that strong among the left; right-wingers should be more persistent, even when Openness increases
 - low-openness $\times$ right-wing: relying fully on ideology, stay with party choice
 - high-openness $\times$ right-wing: taking less ideology cues, but still not switch votes
 - Finding: Openness has a slightly weaker effect for right-leaning individuals. But: Result not significant

$$\beta = -0.19, \quad p = 0.80$$

Extensions: Diagnostics & Interaction Effect II (M2)



Model Comparison

- Adding GAL-TAN variable:
 - **GAL**: Green-Alternative-Libertarian (pro-diversity, pro-immigration, progressive)
 - **TAN**: Traditional-Authoritarian-Nationalist (order, tradition, anti-immigration)
- Improves model fit (AIC: 1346 $\rightarrow$ 1330)
- Has a strong positive and significant effect ($\beta \approx 1.69$, $p < 0.01$)
 - More TAN-oriented individuals are substantially more likely to switch to the AfD
- Left-right ideology remains highly significant but decreases (7.25 $\rightarrow$ 5.98)
 - Indicates that cultural ideology captures part of what left-right previously explained
- Conscientiousness remains robust and significant across models
- Other personality traits remain insignificant

Model Comparison (M2)

Table 3: Logistic Regression Models for Susceptibility to Populism

	<i>Dependent variable: Susceptibility to populism</i>		
	M2	M2 + GAL-TAN	Selected Model
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Openness	0.315 (0.373)	0.465 (0.375)	
Conscientiousness	0.899* (0.471)	0.973** (0.472)	1.061** (0.442)
Extraversion	-0.007 (0.364)	-0.069 (0.367)	
Agreeableness	-0.151 (0.456)	-0.127 (0.456)	
Neuroticism	-0.111 (0.426)	-0.066 (0.426)	

Model Comparison (M2)

Table 3: Logistic Regression Models for Susceptibility to Populism

	<i>Dependent variable: Susceptibility to populism</i>		
	M2 (1)	M2 + GAL-TAN (2)	Selected Model (3)
Left-right self-placement	7.250*** (0.536)	5.978*** (0.621)	5.924*** (0.610)
GAL-TAN		1.686*** (0.430)	1.674*** (0.427)
Age	0.001 (0.005)	-0.00001 (0.005)	
Gender (female)	-0.259 (0.160)	-0.283* (0.160)	-0.284* (0.156)
Region (West Germany)	-0.261 (0.200)	-0.199 (0.201)	
Constant	-5.431*** (0.844)	-5.915*** (0.860)	-5.933*** (0.661)
Observations	3,816	3,816	3,816
Log Likelihood	-656.041	-647.165	-648.355
Akaike Inf. Crit.	1,346.082	1,330.330	1,320.710

Note: * $p < 0.1$; ** $p < 0.05$; *** $p < 0.01$

Conclusion

- Replication overall successful
- Personality matters for general switching, especially Openness and Conscientiousness
- Ideology dominates AfD switching
- Cultural ideology adds explanatory power
- Best model drops some variables that were used in original paper

Questions?